

red flowers with mahogany-speckled, gold throats throughout summer. Z8–10
M. ‘Whitecroft Scarlet’. See *M. cupreus* ‘Whitecroft Scarlet’.

Mina. See *Ipomoea*.

MIRABILIS

NYCTAGINACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering annuals and tuberous perennials. Frost hardy to frost tender. Best grown in a sheltered position in fertile, well-drained soil and in full sun. Lift tubers and store over winter in frost-free conditions. Propagate by seed or division of tubers in early spring.
M. jalapa (Four o’clock flower, Marvel of Peru) illus. p.233.

MISCANTHUS

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.
M. sacchariflorus (Silver banner grass). Vigorous, deciduous, slow-spreading, clump-forming, perennial grass. H 10ft (3m), S indefinite. Hairless, mid-green leaves last into winter, often turning bronze. Produces open, branched panicles of hairy, silvery-white spikelets in summer followed by attractive seedheads. Z4–9
M. sinensis. Deciduous, clump-forming, erect, perennial grass. H 10ft (3m), S 4ft (1.2m). Has mostly basal, flat, arching or erect, linear, blue-green leaves, to 4ft (1.2m) long. Pyramidal plumes of silky-hairy, pale gray spikelets, tinted maroon or purple-brown, are borne in fall. Z5–9.
var. condensatus ‘Cosmopolitan’ illus. p.285. **‘Flamingo’** illus. p.286. **‘Gracillimus’** illus. p.286. **‘Kleine Fontäne’**, H 5ft (1.5m), has narrow leaves and drooping red panicles that quickly turn silver. **‘Morning Light’**, H 4ft (1.2m), resembles ‘Gracillimus’, but has narrow, white leaf margins, giving a silvery effect. **‘Silberfeder’** (syn. *M.s.* ‘Silver Feather’) H to 8ft (2.5m), is free-flowering, and produces silvery to pale pinkish-brown panicles in early and mid-fall, remaining through winter. **‘Silver Feather’** see *M.s.* ‘Silberfeder’. **‘Yakushima Dwarf’** illus. p.285. **‘Zebrinus’** illus. p.284.

MITCHELLA

Partridge berry

RUBIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, trailing perennials, grown for their foliage and fruits. Makes excellent groundcover, especially in woodlands, although is sometimes difficult to establish. Fully hardy. Prefers shade and humus-rich, neutral to acidic soil. Propagate by division of rooted runners in spring or by seed in fall.
M. repens (Creeping box, Partridge berry). Evergreen, trailing, mat-forming perennial. H 2in (5cm), S indefinite. Bears small, ovate, white-veined, green leaves with heart-shaped bases. In early summer has pairs of tiny, fragrant, tubular, white flowers, sometimes purple-tinged, followed by spherical, bright red fruits. Suits a rock garden or peat bed. Z3–8

MITELLA

Bishop’s cap, Mitrewort

SAXIFRAGACEAE

Genus of clump-forming, summer-flowering, slender-stemmed, rhizomatous perennials. Fully hardy. Requires shade and humus-rich, moist soil. Propagate by division in spring or by seed in fall.
M. breweri illus. p.371.

MITRARIA

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen, woody-stemmed, scrambling or spreading shrub. Frost hardy. Needs a position in partial shade and in peaty, acidic soil. Propagate by seed in spring or stem cuttings in summer.
M. coccinea illus. p.193.

MOLINIA

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.
M. altissima. See *M. caerulea* subsp. *arundinacea*.
M. caerulea subsp. arundinacea, syn. *M. altissima*. Tuft-forming, herbaceous, perennial grass. H 8ft (2.5m), S 2ft (60cm). Has broad, flat, gray-green leaves and spreading panicles of purple spikelets on stiff, erect stems in summer. Needs a dry, sunny position and acidic soil. Z4–7. **‘Transparent’** illus. p.286. **‘Windspiel’**, H to 6ft (2m), has airy plumes of yellow-brown flowers. **subsp. caerulea ‘Moorhexe’**, H 3ft (1m), is very upright, with dark purple spikelets held tightly against erect stems. **subsp. caerulea ‘Variegata’**, H 2ft (60cm), has yellow-striped, mid-green leaves and, in late summer, panicles of purplish spikelets.

MOLTKIA

BORAGINACEAE

Genus of perennials, subshrubs, or shrubs, some evergreen, grown for their funnel-shaped flowers in summer. Borderline fully to frost hardy. Prefers sun and well-drained, neutral to alkaline soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or seed in fall.
M. x intermedia. Evergreen, open, dome-shaped subshrub. H 1ft (30cm), S 20in (50cm). Stems are clothed in narrowly linear, dark green leaves. Abundant, loose spikes of small, open funnel-shaped, bright blue flowers are produced in summer. (borderline) Z5–8
M. petraea. Semievergreen, bushy shrub. H 1ft (30cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has long, narrow, hairy leaves and clusters of pinkish-purple buds open into funnel-shaped, violet-blue flowers in summer. (borderline) Z5–8
M. suffruticosa illus. p.342.

MOLUCCELLA

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of erect, branching annuals and short-lived perennials, grown for their flowers, which may be dried for flower arrangements. Frost hardy. Grow in sun and in rich, very well-drained soil. May be

propagated by seed sown under glass in spring, or outdoors in late spring.
M. laevis (Bells of Ireland, Shell flower) illus. p.316.

MONARDA

Bergamot

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of annuals and clump-forming perennials, grown for their aromatic foliage as well as for their flowers. Fully hardy. Requires sun and moist soil. Propagate species and cultivars by division in spring, species only by seed in spring.
M. ‘Adam’. Clump-forming perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Ovate, usually toothed, mid-green leaves are aromatic and hairy. Bears dense whorls of 2-lipped, cerise flowers throughout summer. Z7–11
M. ‘Beauty of Cobham’. Clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has purplish-green leaves. Bears pale pink flowers, with purple-pink bracts, from midsummer to early fall. (borderline) Z4–9
M. ‘Cambridge Scarlet’ illus. p.235. **M. ‘Croftway Pink’** illus. p.233.
M. didyma (Bee balm, Bergamot). Bushy, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (90cm) or more, S 1½ft (45cm). Square stems carry ovate to lance-shaped, dull, mid-green leaves, softly hairy beneath. Each flowering stem bears 2 whorls of bright scarlet or pink flowers, with red-tinged bracts, from mid- to late summer. Z4–9
M. fistulosa illus. p.239.
M. ‘Prairie Night’. See *M. ‘Prärienacht’*. **M. ‘Prärienacht’**, syn. *M. ‘Prairie Night’*. Clump-forming perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 1½ft (45cm). Ovate, toothed leaves are mid-green. Bears dense whorls of rich violet-purple, 2-lipped flowers from midsummer to early fall. (borderline) Z7–11
M. ‘Violet Queen’. Upright, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Bears bright violet-purple flowers above purple-tinged, mid-green leaves throughout summer. (borderline) Z4–9

MONSTERA

ARACEAE

Genus of evergreen, woody-stemmed, often epiphytic root climbers, grown for their large, handsome leaves. Insignificant, creamy-white flowers with hooded spathes are produced intermittently. Frost tender. Provide humus-rich, well-drained soil and light shade in summer. Water moderately, less when temperatures are low. Provide support. If necessary, shorten long stems in spring. Propagate by leaf-bud or stem-tip cuttings in summer. ☉ All parts except the fruit may cause mild stomach upset when ingested, and contact with the fruit may irritate skin.
M. deliciosa (Swiss-cheese plant) illus. p.463.

MORAEA

IRIDACEAE

Genus of deciduous or semi-deciduous corms with short-lived, irislike flowers. Frost hardy to half hardy. Winter-growing species are half hardy, need full sun and well-drained soil; keep dry in summer

during dormancy and start into growth by watering in fall. Summer-growing species are frost hardy and dormant in winter; grow in a sheltered, sunny site and well-drained soil. Propagate winter growers by seed in fall, in spring for summer growers.

M. huttonii illus. p.393.

M. ochroleuca, syn. *Homeria ochroleuca*. Spring- or summer-flowering corm. H to 22in (55cm), S 2–3in (5–8cm). Slender, wiry stems each have 1 or 2 long, narrow, semierect, basal leaves. Bears a succession of upright, scented, cup-shaped to flattish, yellow flowers, each sometimes with a central, orange stain. Z8–11
M. polystachya. Winter-growing corm. H to 1ft (30cm), S 2–3in (5–8cm). Bears long, narrow, semierect, basal leaves. Stem has a succession of erect, flattish, blue or lilac flowers, 3in (8cm) across, in winter to spring. Outer petals each have a central, yellow mark. Z9–11
M. ramosissima. Late spring- to early summer-flowering corm. H 20–48in (50–120cm), S 4in (10cm). Has numerous, semierect, narrowly linear, channeled, basal leaves. Bears yellow flowers, with deeper yellow marks on the inner petals, on many-branched stems. Z9–11
M. sisyrinchium, syn. *Gynandiris sisyrinchium*, *Iris sisyrinchium*, illus. p.419.
M. spathacea. See *M. spathulata*. **M. spathulata**, syn. *M. spathacea*. Summer-growing corm. H to 3ft (1m), S 4–6in (10–15cm). Has one long, narrow, semierect, basal leaf. Tough flower stem bears a succession of up to 5 upward-facing, yellow flowers, 2–3in (5–7cm) across, with reflexed, outer petals, in summer. Z9–11

MORINA

CAPRIFOLIACEAE

Genus of evergreen perennials; the most commonly grown species is *M. longifolia*, for its thistlelike foliage and its flowers. Fully hardy, but protect from drying spring winds. Needs full sun and well-drained, ideally sandy soil. Propagate by division directly after flowering or by seed when fresh, in late summer.
M. longifolia illus. p.231.

MORISIA

CRUCIFERAE/BRASSICACEAE

Genus of one species of compact, rosette-forming perennial with a long tap root. Good for rock gardens and alpine houses. Borderline hardy to fully hardy. Needs sun and gritty, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring or root cuttings in winter.
M. monanthos ‘Fred Hemingway’, illus. p.358.

MORUS

Mulberry

MORACEAE

Genus of deciduous, upright to rounded, shrubs and trees, grown for foliage and edible fruits. Tiny flowers are borne in spring. Fully hardy to frost tender. Requires full sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer or by seed in fall.